



BRIAN VAN DER BRUG Los Angeles Times

WORKERS toil on a farm. A recent raid offers a glimpse of the “emboldened” approach to immigration enforcement that could lie ahead.

ICE raid reflects a new reality

Advocates say agents indiscriminately targeted Kern County farmworkers and day laborers last month.

By REBECCA PLEVIN, ANDREA CASTILLO AND RACHEL URANGA

KERN COUNTY, Calif. — It has been more than six weeks since U.S. Border Patrol agents from the agency’s El Centro sector launched a three-day raid in rural stretches of Kern County, resulting in the detention and deportation of scores of undocumented laborers.

The unusual undertaking — carried out more than 300 miles from El Centro near the U.S.-Mexico border — came at the tail end of the Biden administration. Border Patrol Chief Agent Gregory Bovino, a 25-plus-year veteran who leads the Imperial County unit, headed up the operation without the involvement of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

Three former officials with the Biden administration, who requested anonymity because they were not authorized to share operational details, said Bovino “went rogue” with the January raid. No higher-ups knew about the operation before watching it unfold, two of the former officials said.

Instead, said one, it seemed to be a play by some Border Patrol agents, on the eve of President Trump’s return to office, to “show that there was a new boss coming and that that’s where their loyalties lay.”

[See Immigration, A5]

Registry planned for undocumented

Trump administration warns those in the U.S. illegally that they’ll be punished if they don’t sign up. **NATION, A5**

Landfills to take more debris

Agoura facility will accept fire waste from a wider area, and tonnage limits will rise at two other sites.

By TONY BRISCOE

The Los Angeles County Board of Supervisors voted 5 to 0 Tuesday to allow Calabasas Landfill to accept potentially toxic wildfire debris outside its typical service area and increase the tonnage limits at two other Southern California landfills to accommodate the fire-related waste.

Calabasas Landfill, a county-owned landfill in the unincorporated community of Agoura, is authorized to receive waste only from within a roughly 350-square-mile area, which includes about 70% of the fire-damaged area affected by the Palisades fire. The board unanimously voted to waive that restriction for six months, permitting Calabasas Landfill to receive ash and debris from the entire Palisades fire burn scar — and potentially from the Eaton fire and others.

County supervisors also approved an increase in the daily amount of wildfire debris that can be disposed of at the Sunshine Canyon and Lancaster landfills. Sunshine Canyon Landfill in Sylmar can accept an additional 2,900 tons of solid waste per day and Lancaster Landfill can receive an additional 4,000 tons per day — provided that the additional waste consists only of wildfire debris.

County officials insisted the changes were necessary to swiftly remove potentially toxic-laden debris from properties destroyed in the Eaton and Palisades fires, emphasizing the contaminants pose an immediate threat to public health and the environment in Pacific Palisades and Altadena.

“Some people, they just want nothing,” said Supervisor Lindsey Horvath, whose

[See Landfills, A10]

COLUMN ONE

Black female success story ends in Palisades

In the mid-1960s, Louvenia Jenkins posed a question to her mailman: Do any Black people live in Pacific Palisades?

The mail carrier, a light-skinned Black man, told her there were about half a dozen or so, but they were “all passing.” As in, their skin was light enough that they could pass as white.

Jenkins was then in her late 30s, living in a rented home in Santa Monica. She was an unmarried Black woman with darker skin. And she wanted to buy her own house, in an era when many banks still refused to lend women money without a male co-signer.

When she bought her three-bedroom house on Muskingum Avenue in 1967, Jenkins became one of the first — if not *the* first — Black female homeowners in Pacific Palisades.

Jenkins lived in that house for 57 years. Until Jan. 7.

On the same day the Eaton fire wiped out much of a historic Black enclave in Altadena, the Palisades fire destroyed the home of Jenkins, who was — still — one of the few Black homeowners in mostly white Pacific Palisades.

Jenkins’ house stood as a quiet monument to Black female success. Her white Mercedes sat covered

[See Homeowner, A10]

Louvenia Jenkins bought her home in the overwhelming white enclave in 1967, now lost in the fire. She is starting over at 96.

By HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

LOUVENIA JENKINS, a retired LAUSD principal, has moved to a senior living complex in Culver City. She continues to stay positive.

President, allies target California’s 2035 ban on gas-powered vehicles

Congress might help Trump curtail state’s ability to set its own mileage standards, an industry bellwether.

By FAITH E. PINHO, JAMES RAINEY, JULIA WICK AND MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is escalating its battle with California over the future of gas-powered cars in the United States, plotting a legislative maneuver with congressional Republicans to strip California of a decades-old authority to establish a national fuel-efficiency standard.

Two Trump administration officials confirmed

Wednesday that discussions are underway about invoking the Congressional Review Act to end the decades-old waiver giving California vast sway over mileage standards. The review act allows lawmakers to reverse government rules drafted within a certain window with a simple majority. One GOP lawmaker from California introduced legislation last month to end the federal waiver.

For decades, automakers have bent their car production lines to meet California mileage standards, in part due to the size of the California market and in part because the industry has found it a safer bet — with changes in power so common in Washington — to be more stringent on fuel efficiency standards than the alternative.

[See Emissions, A7]

House paves way for federal cuts

California Republicans back budget resolution that could cost Medicaid and other popular programs. **NATION, A4**

Menendez risk review ordered

Parole board will assess whether brothers who killed parents pose a threat to the public. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

UC employees walk off the job

Overlapping strikes by health, research and tech workers could affect hospitals as well as schools. **BUSINESS, A6**

Weather
Warm, partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 85/53. **B6**

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They voted for Trump, but now they’re losing their government jobs

By JAMES RAINEY

They voted for Donald Trump for president and for a change in the direction of the federal government. But this wasn’t the kind of change they had in mind.

Trump voters who were laid off from their U.S. government jobs by the administration in recent days expressed dismay at what they said has been an unfocused, counterproductive and callous slashing of the federal workforce.

Rather than advancing the efficiency President Trump has said he desires, the fired workers said taxpayers will be losing important services that, for example, helped military veterans cope with financial hardships, searched for drought- and pest-tolerant crops and ensured that medical pro-

viders got Medicare reimbursements.

Some of the workers are appealing to get their jobs back, while others said they are not sure what to do — deeply discouraged that their attempts at public service appeared to be spurned by the new president and some of the public.

“I was thinking that there would be changes,” said a U.S. Department of Agriculture researcher in the mid-Atlantic region who studies drought- and pest-resistant crops. “But instead of being focused, this is just going completely off the rails, chopping and slicing up parts of the government that are protecting Americans.”

The worker — who asked to remain anonymous to increase his chances of regaining his job — said he voted

[See Voters, A7]



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